



### The history of AI

Tracking the story of how AI came to be is a good way to understand what AI is right now. <https://dgit.in/jan20-75>



### AI Everywhere

Five different scenarios for what the world might look like once AI is embedded everywhere. <https://dgit.in/jan20-76>



# ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

The history of the field of study that deals with the anthropomorphism of machines

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he proliferation of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in the 21st century doesn't paint the picture of its history

dating back too far into the past.

However, the concept of mechanised 'humans' first came to be in 380 BC when numerous mathematicians, theologians, professors, philosophers and authors pondered over calculating machines and numeral systems that could 'think' like humans.

Today, we know AI as the broad branch of computer science which concerns itself with 'smart' or intelligent machines that are capable of performing cognitive practices which typically require human intelligence. It is based on the principle that human thought processes can be both replicated and mechanised. Machine learning (ML) is a popular subset of AI which is the method of machines parsing data, learning from that data and then applying it to make an informed decision. Now, we will delve into the origins of AI and how it burgeoned through the years.

## THE EARLY DAYS

As we mentioned above, the history of AI dates all the way back to antiquity when intellectuals mulled over the idea of mechanical 'men' and automatons that could exist in some fashion in the future. They appeared in Greek myths, with some examples being the golden robots of Hephaestus and Pygmalion's Galatea. Fast forward to the early 1700s, Jonathan Swift's renowned novel, 'Gulliver's Travels' incorporated



Gakutensoku, the first robot in Japan which could move its head and change facial expressions

a device termed 'the engine', which was akin to computers today. The device's intended purpose was to improve operations and knowledge by lending its assistance and learning to skill-less people. In 1872, Samuel Bulter, an author, wrote 'Erewhon' which toyed with the idea of machines in the future possessing consciousness.

Thanks to these early thinkers, philosophers, mathematicians and logicians were instigated to develop mechanised 'humans'. In 1929, Makoto Nishimura, a Japanese biologist and professor, built the first robot in Japan called 'Gakuten-soku' which translates to 'learning from the laws of nature'. This implied that the robot could derive knowledge from people and nature.

These advancements led to the invention of a programmable digital computer called the Atanasoff Berry Computer (ABC) by John Vincent Atanasoff, a physicist and inventor, alongside his assistant Clifford Berry in 1939. The ABC could solve up to 29 linear equations simultaneously and further inspired scientists to create